

Generative AI in Creative Practice

Generative artificial intelligence (AI) refers to technology that can create new content by identifying and using patterns learned from extensive datasets. Depending on the model, generative AI can produce images, music, text, video, 3D objects, and other media in response to prompts or other user inputs. My current understanding is that generative AI does not merely replicate existing works. Instead, it synthesizes learned patterns to generate novel outputs. However, questions regarding originality, authorship, copyright, bias, and the sources used to train these systems remain significant.

Within creative disciplines, generative AI serves as both a tool and a collaborator. Artists may use image-generation systems to explore visual concepts, experiment with styles, create concept art, or develop references for larger projects. Writers can use AI to brainstorm ideas and draft, while musicians can experiment with AI-generated sounds and compositions. In game development, generative AI can also help develop character concepts, environments, dialogue, and other aspects of creative prototyping. I find this particularly compelling because it accelerates experimentation while still reserving essential creative decisions for the human artist.

One generative AI-driven artwork that I find particularly inspiring is “Unsupervised” by Refik Anadol. This work uses artificial intelligence and extensive datasets to create an evolving visual installation. I find it inspiring because it shows how AI can be integrated into the artistic process, rather than serving solely as a tool for producing a finished image. The constantly changing visuals create an experience that feels alive and unpredictable.

What interests me most about generative AI is the relationship between human creativity and machine-generated possibilities. I see AI as a way to explore ideas that might not otherwise be considered. At the same time, the artist’s choices about what to request, what to retain, what to modify, and how to present the result remain essential to imparting meaning to the work.